

Informed Consent



Informed Consent

- Data collectors must ensure that data ONLY comes from individuals who understand what they are agreeing to do.
- It is never appropriate to interview someone who does not have a full understanding of the purpose of the research and their role in the research.
- Participants should understand the risks and benefits of participating in the study, as well as their right NOT to participate.
- Informed consent/assent is how we ensure this understanding

Informed Consent

- All participation, from every research subject is **voluntary**, so no one is required to take part in the study, and everyone has the right to refuse.
- Even if someone agrees to participate in the study they can refuse to answer certain questions or sections.
- In order to educate participants about their rights as a potential research subject, **the informed consent process must happen at the start of every interview.**
- The informed consent process includes reading a document to participants that summarizes the goals and timeline of the research, the risks and benefits and their right to participate or decline.
- Once the research subject has reviewed the informed consent document and has had the opportunity to ask questions about the study, they can decide if they would like to participate.
- It is the data collector's responsibility to make sure that participants understand the consent procedure and truly agree to participate in the study, with minimal influence from anyone else (including parents, community members, or you).

Who is priority for consent/assent and interview?



Core Respondent =
Adolescent

Two Cases:

1. CR living with Parent/
Guardian
2. CR living alone/ married

Determining whether CR lives with Parent/Guardian



Upon arrival at a selected household:

Locate an adult household member to speak to.

- Preferably an elder in the HH, HH head, or the wife of the HH head
- The selected adult should not be the spouse of the CR

If an adult is available:

- Follow instructions for [Obtaining Consent/Assent for Adolescent living with a Parent/Guardian](#)

If there is no adult available:

- ***Determine if an adult is ever available***
 - **If yes:** schedule time for a revisit at a later time
 - **If no:** Follow instructions for [Obtaining Consent for Adolescent living Alone/Married](#)

Obtaining Consent/Assent for Adolescent Living with a Parent/Guardian (1/2)



1. Introduce yourself and your purpose

- i. Address any questions or concerns
- ii. Ask to speak with a parent/guardian

2. Obtain parent/guardian consent

- i. **If consent is NOT obtained**, end interview and note reasons on tracking sheet. We will not attempt to interview anyone in the household if parent/guardian consent is not obtained. There will be no further communication with this household. Inform your supervisor.
- ii. **If consent is obtained**, ask to be introduced to the CR

“I would like to speak to [CR name], to determine whether s/he is interested in participating in this research study. Would you please introduce me to her/him?”

Obtaining Consent/Assent for Adolescent Living with a Parent/Guardian (2/2)

Upon introduction to CR:

3. Obtain Adolescent Assent

- i. **If assent is NOT obtained**, end interview and note reasons on tracking sheet.

We will not attempt to interview anyone in the household if CR consent/assent is not obtained.

BUT you should use good judgement, so that we don't miss opportunities

- ii. **If assent is obtained**, continue.



Obtaining Consent for Adolescent Living Alone

1. *Introduce yourself to the CR and state your purpose*
2. *Obtain Adolescent Consent*
 - i. If adolescent consent is NOT obtained, end interview and note reasons on tracking sheet.

We will not attempt to interview anyone in the household if CR consent/assent is not obtained.

BUT you should use good judgement, so that we don't miss opportunities

- ii. If consent is obtained, continue.



Obtaining Consent for Married Adolescent (1/2)

1. *Introduce yourself to the CR and state your purpose*
2. *If the CR is married to an adult*
3. **Obtain Adolescent Consent**
 - i. Attempt to obtain parental consent
 - ii. Obtain the adult partner's consent if parents are unreachable
 - iii. If adolescent consent is NOT obtained, end interview and note reasons on tracking sheet.

We will not attempt to interview anyone in the household if CR consent/assent is not obtained.

BUT you should use good judgement, so that we don't miss opportunities

- iv. If consent is obtained, continue.



Obtaining Consent for Married Adolescent (2/2)

1. *Introduce yourself to the CR and state your purpose*
2. *In case CR and husband are both a minor*
3. **Obtain Adolescent Consent**
 - i. Attempt to obtain parental consent
 - ii. Obtain the participant's consent if parents are unreachable
 - iii. If adolescent consent is NOT obtained, end interview and note reasons on tracking sheet.

We will not attempt to interview anyone in the household if CR consent/assent is not obtained.

BUT you should use good judgement, so that we don't miss opportunities

- iv. If consent is obtained, continue.



Obtaining Consent for Adult Female Survey Respondents (1/2)

CR with Parent/Guardian

*Relocate the Parent/
Guardian*

- Ask for possible AF Survey respondent

CR married, not living with a parent/guardian

Continue speaking with CR

- Ask for possible AF Survey respondent

CR living alone

Continue speaking with CR

- The CR will be the respondent to the AF Survey

Obtaining Consent for Adult Female Survey Respondents (2/2)

Locate the relevant AF member to be surveyed

1. Obtain Adult Female Survey Respondent Consent



Identifying the AF Survey Respondent (1/2)

Key Criteria

1. Adult Female
2. (Most heavily) involved in decision-making or caregiving of the CR
3. Lives in household

What if this person does not consent or is not available?



Identifying the AF Survey Respondent (2/2)

YOUNG COHORT

1. AF in HH involved in decision-making/caregiving of CR
2. AF in HH

If **ALL** options for AF in the HH have been exhausted:

3. AM in HH involved in decision-making/caregiving of CR
4. AM in HH

If **ALL** options for AM in the HH have been exhausted:

There will be no AF Survey for HH.

OLD COHORT

1. AF in HH involved in decision-making/caregiving of CR
2. AF in HH

If **ALL** options for AF in the HH have been exhausted:

3. AM in HH involved in decision-making/caregiving of CR
4. AM in HH

If **ALL** options for AM in the HH have been exhausted:

5. The CR can be the AF Respondent

Household Interview

Begin interview.



1. AF interview

- a. If AF has consented, start by interviewing her.
- b. If no AF has consented, but an AM has consented, start by interviewing him.

2. CR interview

Key Differences in Gaining Consent for an Adolescent living alone/married



1. Be sure that an adult NEVER lives in the home OR the CR is living with a spouse
2. Different Introductory Script
3. No need for consent from a Parent/Guardian
Consent of Adolescent vs.
Consent of Parent/Guardian and Assent of Adolescent

Key Difference in AF Respondent for Old vs. Young Cohort

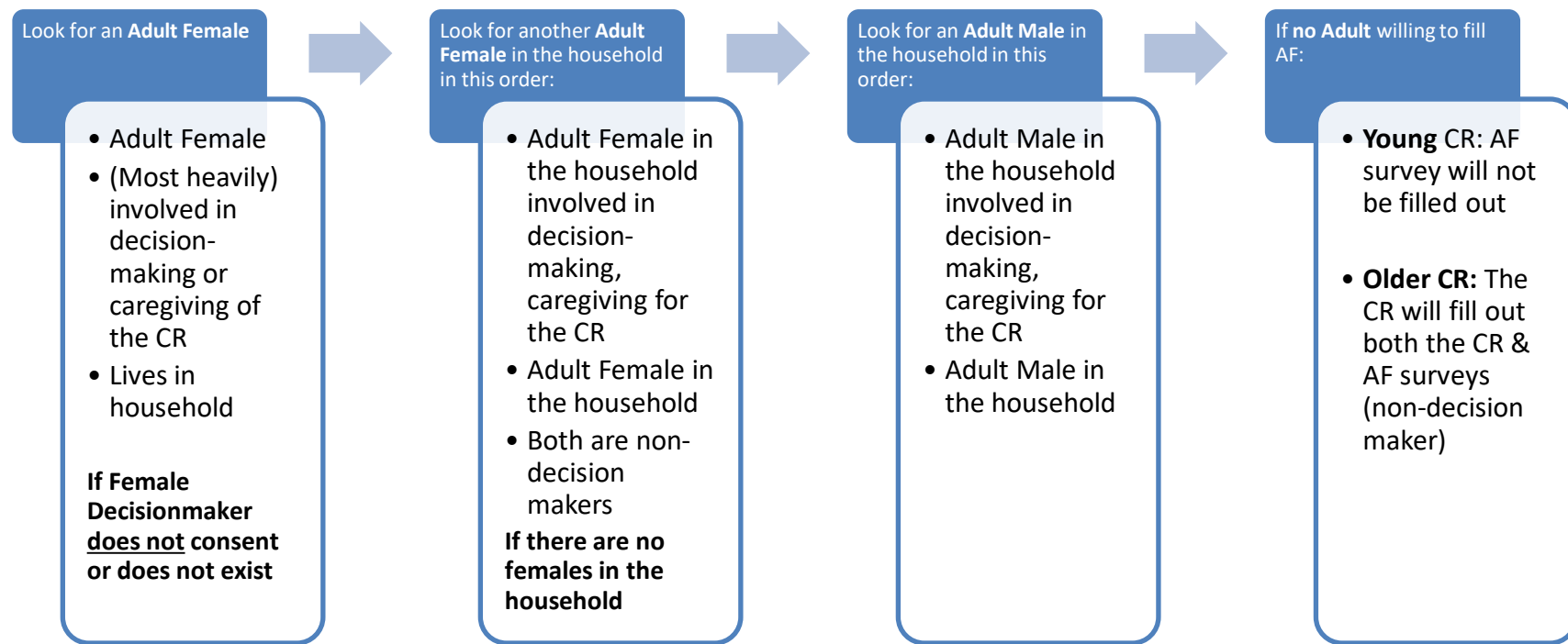


If There is no Adult in the HH for the AF Survey:

- Old Cohort CRs can respond to the AF survey
- Young Cohort CRs cannot respond to the AF Survey
 - There will be no AF Survey completed in this case

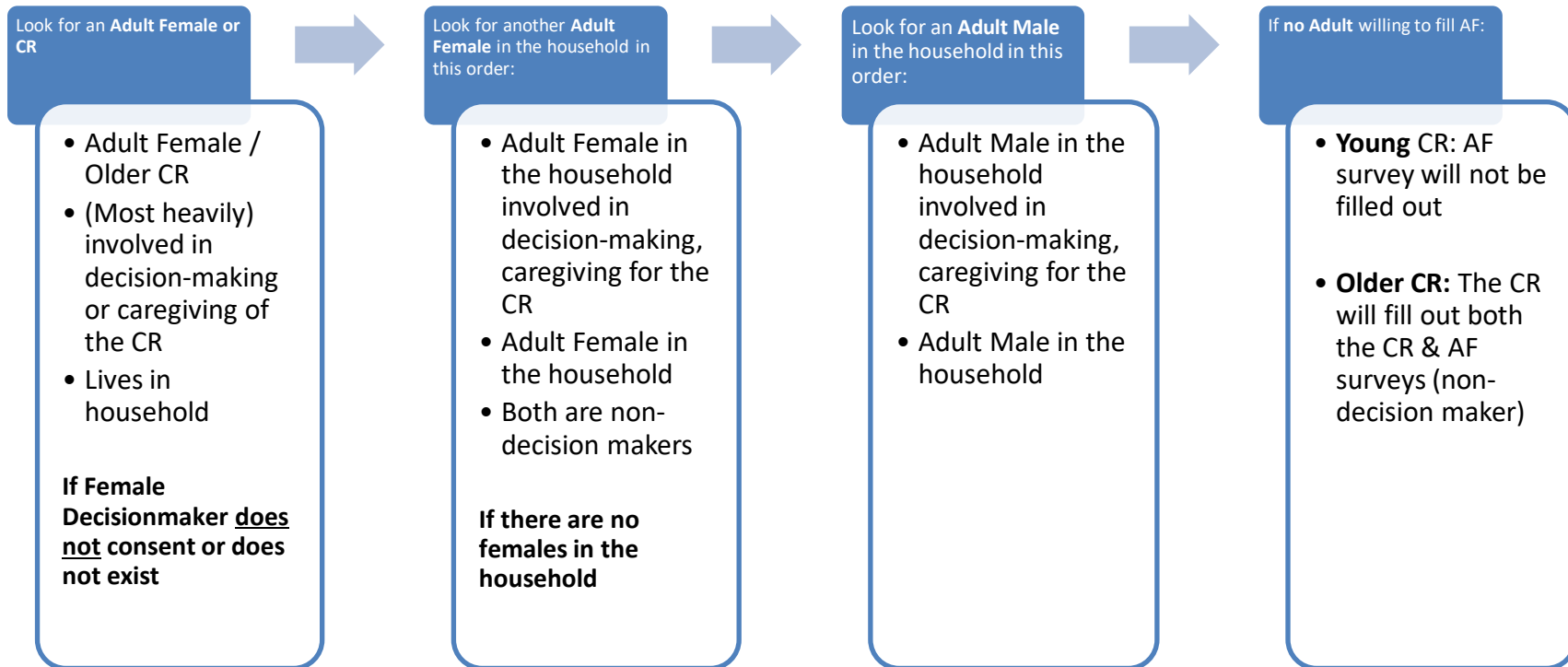
Respondent Scenarios (AF Module)

1. Regular scenario:



Respondent Scenarios (AF Module)

2. Female CR is married:



Respondent Scenarios (AF Module)

3. CR is living alone:

- Try and get parental consent
- If not possible:
 - Young CR: Fill out CR survey **only**
 - Older CR: The CR will fill out both the CR & AF surveys (non-decision maker)

Let's Practice

How would you respond to the following questions and comments?

- Why was I/my household selected?
- What types of questions will you ask me?
- The [CR] may participate, but the [AF] must sit in the room with him/her.
- I don't want to participate, but I think my relative should.
- Can my relative sit with me, while I participate?
- How long will this take?
- I don't have time to do this.
- Can you come back another day?
- The CR has chores/school work to do, she shouldn't participate?



QUESTIONS?



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